

# THE BLACK PANTHER

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## INSIDE

•Oakland Police Murder  
Black Man

PAGE 5

•Unemployment Benefits:  
Fight For Your Rights

PAGE 12

•FRELIMO Attacks  
Capitalism In Mozambique

CENTERFOLD

•Hilarious Richard Pryor  
Album Reviewed

PAGE 21

## \$20 Million Anti-Discrimination Suit

# BLACK COPS SUE FEDERAL CRIME AGENCY



From left to right, Pastor J. ALFRED SMITH, spokesman of the Community Coalition Against Racism in Oakland; RAYMOND CLARK, president of the Oakland Black Officers Association; OLLIE GLOVER, a co-founder of the National Black Police Association (NBPA); SANDRE SWANSON, administrative aide to California Congressman Ronald V. Dellums, announce filing of \$20 million class action lawsuit against the Law Enforcement Assistance Administration (LEAA).

(San Francisco, Calif.) - Raymond Clark, a patrolman in the Oakland, California, Police Department, president of the Oakland Black Officers Association (OBOA) and information officer for Region 5 of the National Black Police Association (NBPA), and Ollie Glover, a sergeant in the Richmond, California, Police Department and a cofounder of the NBPA, have filed a \$20 million class action lawsuit against officials of the Law Enforcement Assistance Administration (LEAA) and the U.S. attorney general on behalf of minority and women police officers throughout the nation, it was announced here in a major press conference last Thursday.

Included among the named plaintiffs in the suit are the NBPA, the International Association of Women Police (U.S., U.K. and Canada) and 10 individuals. The plaintiffs charge in the suit that they along with other members of the class have been discriminated against in employment on the grounds of race and sex by their police departments, which receive federal funding from LEAA.

The lawsuit, filed in the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia, is being handled by the American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU). David M. Fishlow, executive director of the ACLU of Northern California, told the assembled media (as well as representatives of the Black police officers' organizations of Oakland, San Francisco and Richmond):

CONTINUED ON PAGE 22

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